DDD-P-66B
June 29, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. DDD-P-0066A(GSA-FSS)
March 3, 1964 and
Fed. Spec. DDD-P-66
June 3, 1954

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAD, SANITARY

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers pads used primarily for the absorption of menses. They are also known as sanitary napkins, maternity pads, etc.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Grade designation. The pads covered by this specification shall be of one grade and the following commercial designations:

Regular
Super

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies).

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Pads covered by this specification shall be of soft absorbent filler material formed into a rectangular shape. The ends of the filler may be rounded or tapered. The filler material shall be covered with a gauze or non-woven fabric covering, completely enclosing the absorbent filler and extending beyond the length of the filler to form tabs at each end for securing the pad in use. The completed pad shall meet the requirements as given in table I when tested as specified in section 4.

3.2 Absorbent filler. The absorbent filler shall be white, free from lumps, oil spots, dirt or foreign material. The filler shall be arranged in a manner that will distribute the menses flow in the absorbent material. Nonabsorbent barriers may be utilized in the construction to assist in accomplishing even distribution. The filler material shall be free from acid, alkali and dyes. The pH shall be not less than 4.5 nor more than 9.5 when tested as specified in 4.3.3. The ash content shall not exceed 1.5 percent when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

3.3 Covering. The covering of the absorbent filler shall be a good quality gauze or a non-woven fabric with sufficient porosity to permit the assembled pad to meet the absorbency requirements. The covering shall be sealed or secured in a manner that will prevent its unwrapping from the absorbent filler under normal handling. The covering shall extend beyond each end of the absorbent filler to form tabs for securing in use. Tabs shall be within the length specified in table I. The breaking strength of each pad shall be not less than 14 pounds when tested as described in 4.3.5. If a non-absorbent barrier is used, the covering shall have an identifying thread or marking indicating side of this barrier.

3.4 Dimensions, weight, absorbency and chemical requirements.

TABLE I.

Characteristics	Regular	Super	Paragraph
Filler width	2.5 in. min.	2.5 in. min.	4.3.1.1
Filler length	7.5 in. min.	7.5 in. min.	4.3.1.2
Filler thickness	.55 in. min.	.60 in. min.	4.3.1.3
Pad overall length	18 in. min.	18 in. min.	4.3.1.4
Front tab length	4 in. ± 1 in.	4 in. ± 1 in.	4.3.1.5
Pad weight	15 gram max.	20 gram max.	4.3.1.6
Pad absorbency	30 ml. min.	40 ml. min.	4.3.2
Acid-alkali, pH	4.5 - 9.5	4.5 - 9.5	4.3.3
Ash, percent max.	1.5	1.5	4.3.4
Pad breaking strength, lbs. min.	14	14	4.3.5

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3.5 Workmanship. The pads shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which may affect their utility. The pads shall be manufactured and packaged under clean and sanitary conditions.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as the process of measuring, examining, testing or otherwise comparing the unit of product with the requirements.

4.1.2 Unit of product for the purpose of this specification is one pad.

4.1.3 The lot size shall be the number of units of product of one size submitted at one time for inspection.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection level shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 Level S-3 for all tests except acid-alkali, ash content and pad breaking strength. The acceptance number shall be zero defects.

4.2.2 The sample size for acid-alkali and ash content shall be two. The acceptance number shall be zero defects.

4.2.3 The sample size for pad breaking strength shall be five pads. The pad breaking strength shall be the average of the results obtained from the five pad specimens.

4.3 Test.

4.3.1 Dimensions and weight.

4.3.1.1 Filler width shall be measured using standard measuring instruments. The measurement shall be made on the completed pad.

4.3.1.2 The filler length shall be made by folding the tabs over at the end of filler and measuring filler length.

4.3.1.3 The filler thickness shall be made by stacking 10 complete pads and measuring the stack height. The average thickness for the 10 pads shall be used as the pad thickness.

4.3.1.4 The overall length shall be measured by laying pad with tabs unfolded on a flat surface.

4.3.1.5 The front tab length shall be measured with pad unfolded as for overall length.

4.3.1.6 The pad weight shall be taken as the average weight of the entire sample.

4.3.2 Pad absorbency. The pad absorbency shall be determined by laying the pad on a flat level transparent surface so the underside of the pad can be observed. A mirror placed under the suspended surface will facilitate observation of the underside of the pad. A one percent dye solution made with distilled water, is applied to the center of the pad. Temperature of the dye solution is 73°F ± 3°. The dye solution is applied to the center of the pad from a burette at the rate of 15 ml/min. ± 3 ml from a height of approximately one inch. The test shall be stopped at the first sign of a shiny wet spot on the underside of the pad. This end-point shall be confirmed by raising the pad and inspecting the bottom surface for the presence of a wet spot. If none is there, the pad should be returned to the surface and the flow of dye solution continued until a wet spot does appear. The volume of dye solution in milliliters to the end-point of the test shall be used

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as the absorbency for the pad. The average for the entire sample shall be used as the absorbency of the pads for acceptance requirements.

4.3.3 Acidity-alkalinity. The pH of the absorbent material shall be determined in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191, Test Method 2811.

4.3.4 Ash. The specimen shall consist of small pieces of filler material so selected as to be representative of the absorbent materials. Its total weight shall be not less than 1 gram. The specimen shall be dried to constant weight at 100° to 105° C. and weighed to the nearest milligram. A crucible, such as platinum, alundum, porcelain, or silica, having a tightly fitting lid shall be used for ignition. The crucible shall be covered during the initial ignition period which is done at a low temperature. After this period the temperature shall be gradually raised to a maximum of about 925°C. After this temperature is reached, the lid of the crucible may be slid to one side until the combustion is complete. The contents of the crucible shall be protected from air drafts. When the filler is completely burned, as indicated by the absence of black particles, the crucible shall be removed from the muffle, cooled in a desiccator, and weighed. Repeat the ignition and weighing until the weight is constant. The percentage of ash shall be calculated on the basis of the weight of the specimen when dried to constant weight at 100° to 105°C.

4.3.5 Pad breaking strength. The breaking strength of the pad shall be determined in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191, Test Method 5100. The design of each clamp shall be such that the width of the face of the jaws is greater than the width of the specimen. Elongation measurements are not required. Test shall be made in the longitudinal direction of the specimen only. The average breaking strength for the sample shall be used as the breaking strength of the pad.

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers. Cushioning inadequate, improper or missing.

4.4.1 Examination of closure and reinforcement for containers. When shipping containers are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix to that specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Pads of one grade shall be packaged in quantities of 12 or 40, as specified (see 6.1), in a box conforming to PPP-B-566. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Pads shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

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5.2.1 Level A. Pads of one grade packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities (see 6.1) in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Pads of one grade packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities of 12 or 40 unit packages as specified (see 6.2) in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2.1 Bulk packing. Twelve hundred regular grade pads or six hundred super grade pads packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 275. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Pads in quantities as specified (see 6.2), packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination. Containers shall be in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordnace with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Commercial designation of pad desired (see 1.2).
(c) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Quantity required (see 5.2.2, 5.2.2.1, and 5.2.3).
(e) Marking document required (see 5.3).

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army - DM

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

HEW-HSM
VA-DMS

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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